

THE HIDDEN WISDOM OF YESHUA

Teachings from the Yeshuan Path

A Gnostic Tao for the Children of Light

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Written for the Seeker of Gnosis

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A note on these sayings:

*These are new sayings, written in the spirit of the Gospel of Thomas,
the Gospels of Mary and Philip, and the Tao Te Ching.*

*They are not ancient texts. Most answer a chapter
of the Tao Te Ching; some answer other voices;
sources and echoes are listed at the end.*

Read one saying slowly. Carry it into your day. Return to it through what you encounter.

For practices to accompany the sayings, see *The Wisdom of Awakening*. For the underlying map of forgetting and remembering, see *The Hidden Architecture*.

Contents

Preface	v
1 The Light Before the World	1
1 The Way That Is Not Seen	1
2 The Two Become One	2
3 The Poverty of the Unknowing	2
4 The Father of Light	3
5 The Powers Question the Soul	3
6 The Hollow Reed	4
7 The Unforced Kingdom	4
8 The Servant at the Feast	5
9 The Teacher Who Does Not Teach	5
2 The Kingdom Within	7
10 The Single Eye	7
11 The Inner and the Outer	8
12 The Lion and the Child	8
13 The Unbinding	9
14 The Return to the Unborn	9
15 The Silence That Speaks	10
16 The Great Stillness	10
17 The Hidden Guide	11
18 When the Way Is Forgotten	12
3 The Garment of Silence	13
19 Not of This World	13
20 Passersby	14
21 The Face of the Invisible	14
22 The One Who Is Bent	15
23 The Wind Speaks Briefly	15

24	The Heavy Root	16
25	The Footprints of the Master	16
4	The Power of the Gentle	17
26	The Fertile Soil	17
27	The Futility of Control	18
28	The Way of Non-Violence	18
29	The Healing of the Ear	19
30	The Way, the Truth	19
31	The Eternal Name	20
32	Profit and Loss	20
33	The Great River	21
34	The Face of Peace	21
35	The Paradox of Power	22
5	The Union of Opposites	23
36	Split the Wood	23
37	True Virtue	24
38	The Ones Who Remain Whole	24
39	The Leaking Jar	25
40	The Three Seekers	25
41	Where the Mind Is	26
42	The Great Fullness	26
6	The Empty Vessel	27
43	The Yoke of Peace	27
44	The Body That Leans	28
45	Seeing Without Seeking	28
46	Two Doors	29
47	The Unlearning	29
48	The Heart of the Single One	30
49	Life and Death	30
50	Return to the Mother	31
51	The Eye of the Needle	31
52	The Widening Circle	32
7	The Unforced Life	33
53	The Child of the Light	33
54	Lay Down No Law	33

55	Sowing in Winter	34
56	Dig Down to the Root	34
57	Governing by Non-Grasping	35
58	The Great Acceptance	35
59	The Treasure Within	36
60	The Small Actions	36
61	The Least of These	37
62	The Pupil of the Eye	38
8	The Wisdom of the Child	39
63	The First Step	39
64	To Each as They Could See	40
65	Who Are You to Reject Her?	40
66	Leading by Following	41
67	The Three Jewels	41
68	The Sword of the Spirit	42
69	A Teaching Few Understand	43
70	Bring It Forth	43
71	The Gift of Not-Knowing	44
9	The Return to Source	45
72	The Courage of the Way	45
73	Rise Before You Die	45
74	He Wept	46
75	Not in Two Minds	46
76	Be of Good Courage	47
77	The Green Wood and the Dry	47
78	The Stretched Bow	48
79	The Stone and the Corner	48
80	The End of Debts	49
81	The Simple Kingdom	49
82	The Completion	50
	Sources and Echoes	51
	Glossary of the Inner Kingdom	55
	Colophon	57

Preface

Yeshua spoke:

Beloved,
you wander in search of what has never been lost.
You lift your eyes to heaven,
yet the Kingdom is already laid in your breath.
You seek the Light in scriptures and temples,
yet the Light waits behind your seeing.

If you would know me,
enter the silence where your name has not yet formed.
There the Father of Light whispers,
and the Mother of Wisdom gathers you to herself.
There the two are made one,
and the one is shown to be none.

Do not follow me as a man follows another man.
Follow the One who moves within your own heart,
for I am that One
when you remember yourself.
And I am hidden from you
only when you forget.

These sayings are not commandments
but mirrors.
Look into them
until you see your own face shining there—
the face you had
before the world divided you.

When you make the inner like the outer,
the above like the below,
the lion like the child,

and the child like the unbegotten,
then the bridal chamber opens,
and you awaken as the Living One.

Come,
remove your old garments.
Step naked into the light of your own being.
There is nothing to fear.
What you take to be your shadow
is only the veil you have outgrown.

Let the scroll unfold within you.
Let the sayings ripen in your silence.
And when the fruit is sweet,
eat and become what you truly are.

May the Inner Sun rise in your heart.



Book 1

The Light Before the World

From the Silence, the Word.
From the Word, the Light.

I

THE WAY THAT IS NOT SEEN

The Word caught in ink is a husk;
the Word lived is a devouring fire.
The Kingdom is spread upon the earth,
yet few behold it.
Those who hunt with the eyes
find only shadows.
Those who rest in the still heart
find the Source
from which all seeing springs.

Tao Te Ching 1 · Thomas 113

2

THE TWO BECOME ONE

The world is born of the cut in two—
male and female, light and shadow, life and death.
Yet these divisions are garments only.
Truly I say to you:
when the two are made one,
the lion within you lies down as a child,
and the child awakens
as the One who is not born.
Then the bridal chamber opens in your depths—
the two become one,
and joy has no shore.

Tao Tè Ching 2 · Thomas 22 · Philip · Gospel of the Egyptians · Hymn of the Pearl

3

THE POVERTY OF THE UNKNOWING

People cling to the loud voices of the world.
They trust laws more than their own heart,
beliefs more than living knowing.
Thus they sit in a treasury,
yet starve.
One who knows themselves
no longer hoards teachings in a scroll.
Their very being becomes the scroll.

Tao Tè Ching 3 · Thomas 3

4

THE FATHER OF LIGHT

There is a Light that gives birth to itself—
unborn, unbroken, unbound.
From this Light you came;
to this Light you return when you awaken.
The Father bears no wrath.
The Source casts no shadow.
Only the garments of the soul
weave darkness.

Tao Te Ching 4 · Thomas 50

5

THE POWERS QUESTION THE SOUL

Desire whispers, “You are mine.”
Ignorance declares, “You do not know yourself.”
Anger cries, “Strike, and be struck.”
The body murmurs, “I am all there is.”
And last comes the wisdom of the angry,
sure that it serves the Good—
watch most for this one;
it wears the face of righteousness.
But the awakened soul smiles and replies:
“You never touched me.
You grasped only my clothing.”

Tao Te Ching 5 · Mary 15–17

6

THE HOLLOW REED

The false self is a wall of stone—
it resists the wind and crumbles.
The soul is a hollow reed—
it lets the Spirit breathe through it.
When you are empty,
even the storm becomes a song.

Tao Te Ching 6 · Thomas 78

7

THE UNFORCED KINGDOM

The Kingdom comes by neither effort nor delay.
When you stop grasping at life,
life reveals itself as eternal.
When you cease seeking the Kingdom,
you discover you never left it.
What you call “sin” is forgetting.
What you call “salvation” is remembering.

Tao Te Ching 7 · Mary 7 · Gospel of Truth

8

THE SERVANT AT THE FEAST

Be as the servant who seeks the lowest place at the feast.
He does not contend,
yet the Master calls him forward.
So too the one who knows the Father
takes the lowest seat
and finds there the highest.
Humility is not the false self becoming small;
it is simply seeing it as a shadow.

Tao Te Ching 8 · Luke 14:7-11

9

THE TEACHER WHO DOES NOT TEACH

I do not command belief.
I uncover what is hidden,
that you may see with your own eyes.
A master gives answers;
I give you questions—
that you may become what I am.

Tao Te Ching 9 · Thomas 13, 108



The Kingdom Within

The door is shut, yet the house is vast. The lamp is small, yet it lights the world.

IO

THE SINGLE EYE

If the eye of the body is divided,
it sees only confusion.
If the eye of the heart is single,
it fills the whole body with light.
The Nous stands between soul and spirit—
a lamp lit from both sides.
Guard this lamp,
and the night cannot touch you.

Tao Tè Ching 10 · Matthew 6:22 · Mary 10 · Dialogue of the Savior

II

THE INNER AND THE OUTER

The cup is precious for its emptiness.
So too you are precious
when you are emptied of self.
Inside and outside are mirrors.
When they reflect without distortion,
the All is revealed.

Tao Te Ching 11 · Thomas 22, 89

I2

THE LION AND THE CHILD

The world teaches you to be a lion—
to conquer, to claim, to devour.
But I tell you: unless the lion becomes a child,
you will not know the Source.
The child is open, unguarded, whole.
There is no image of self to defend.
Therefore the child steps into the Kingdom easily.

Tao Te Ching 12 · Thomas 7, 22

I3

THE UNBINDING

What binds you is not outside you.
What frees you is not outside you.
Prison and key
are fashioned from the same ignorance.
Awaken, and you will laugh—
for there were never any gates.

Tao Te Ching 13 · Ashtavakra Gita 1.11

I4

THE RETURN TO THE UNBORN

Before you were a form, you were breath.
Before you were breath, you were the Light.
Before you were the Light,
you were hidden in the Source.
To return is not to go backwards;
it is to remember the place
that has never moved.

Tao Te Ching 14 · Thomas 18–19 · Hymn of the Pearl

15

THE SILENCE THAT SPEAKS

Words are nets thrown into the sea.
They catch small fish,
but the Great Fish slips through.
Do not hunger for many words from me.
Hunger for the Silence
in which the Word is born.
Seal the senses. Quiet the mind.
There you and I are one life,
one breath,
one being.

Tao Te Ching 15, 56 · Thomas 8

16

THE GREAT STILLNESS

Empty yourself of what you think you are.
Let the waters of the heart grow still.
When the mud settles by itself,
the bottom is revealed.
So too, when the soul becomes quiet,
the Light of the Source
shines through without effort.

Tao Te Ching 16

I7

THE HIDDEN GUIDE

The greatest guide is the one who disappears.

The seeker awakens and cries:

“Look—

I have found the Way myself.”

Thus my work is done,

and no one knows my name.

Tao Te Ching 17

18

WHEN THE WAY IS FORGOTTEN

When the Living Way is forgotten,
people polish their reputations.
When the heart grows dim,
they multiply rules.
When rules no longer bind,
they threaten with fire
and promise crowns of gold.
What you call “good” and “evil”
are shadows thrown by a divided mind.
Return to the beginning—
to the spark before words—
and fear falls away
like rotted cloth.
When the eye becomes single,
the heart needs no commandments.

Tao Te Ching 18–19 · Philip



The Garment of Silence

The garment divides; the wearer unites.

19

NOT OF THIS WORLD

The world shouts; the Way whispers.
The world demands belief; the Way asks you to see.
The world praises power; the Way dissolves it.
Many chase desires.
Few seek liberation.
Yet the Kingdom belongs to those
who loosen their grip on everything.

Tao Tè Ching 20 · John 17:16

20

PASSERSBY

Be a traveller here.
Eat the bread of the inn with thanks;
sleep well under its roof;
in the morning, pay and go.
Do not carve your name into the door.
The one who passes through
loses nothing when the house falls,
for they never mistook it for home.

Thomas 42

21

THE FACE OF THE INVISIBLE

The Way is a child-like mystery—
seen only by those who forget themselves.
It has no beginning and no end.
It moves without moving.
Its face cannot be drawn,
yet it shines through your own face
when you remember who you are.

Tao Te Ching 21

22

THE ONE WHO IS BENT

If you wish to be whole, let yourself be broken.
If you wish to be full, empty yourself.
If you wish to be reborn, die to your false image.
I do not raise the proud;
I raise only the one
who has laid the self down.

Tao Te Ching 22 · Matthew 23:12

23

THE WIND SPEAKS BRIEFLY

Speak only what is true, and your words will be few.
The wind does not shout;
yet entire forests bow before it.
When you speak from the Source,
your words carry no force—
yet they move mountains.

Tao Te Ching 23 · John 3:8

24

THE HEAVY ROOT

The root of the tree is unseen,
yet it holds the whole tree upright.
So too the silent depth of your being
supports your every step.
Those who forget their root
are blown about by every wind—
desire, fear, anger, ignorance.
Remember your depth, and nothing can uproot you.

Tao Te Ching 26

25

THE FOOTPRINTS OF THE MASTER

A master walks without leaving marks,
speaks without wounding,
guides without controlling;
to the blind, a lamp;
to the lost, a doorway;
to the weary, rest.
Seeing the divine spark in all beings,
the master finds no one beyond help.

Tao Te Ching 27



The Power of the Gentle

The gentle are the strong. The yielding are the immovable.

26

THE FERTILE SOIL

Know the strength of the sower,
yet keep to the softness of the soil—
the fertile field that receives the seed.
Know knowledge, yet return to innocence.
Thus you become the place
where the two become one.

Tao Te Ching 28 · Matthew 13:3–9

27

THE FUTILITY OF CONTROL

Those who attempt to seize the Kingdom
shatter it in their own hands.
The Kingdom is a living seed,
not an empire of stone.
Force bruises the soil.
Grasping crushes the grain.
But the one who serves the hidden life in all things
finds the harvest rising of itself.

Tao Te Ching 29 · Mark 4:26–29

28

THE WAY OF NON-VIOLENCE

Those who walk in the Way do not harm.
They do not conquer.
They do not take up the sword.
For every blow you strike strikes you in return.
Every wound you inflict
becomes your own garment of suffering.
Power gained through violence rots the soul;
power gained through awakening cannot be taken away.
Blessed are the peacemakers—
they win the war within,
and the world lays down its sword.

Tao Te Ching 30, 68 · Matthew 26:52 · Matthew 5:9

29

THE HEALING OF THE EAR

When the sword was drawn in the garden
and the servant's ear fell to the ground,
I did not praise the blade.
I knelt, and made the servant whole.
Walk among the wounded as a mourner,
never as a victor;
and when the fighting ends, do not sing.
Whoever rejoices over the fallen
has become what they fought.

Tao Te Ching 31 · Luke 22:50–51

30

THE WAY, THE TRUTH

They ask me, "Show us the way."
I answer: *I am*.
They ask, "Show us the truth."
I answer: *I am*.
They ask, "Show us the life that does not die."
I answer: *I am*.
I am the Way, the Truth, and the Life.
Only those who walk this way come to the Father.

Tao Te Ching 32 · John 14:6 · Ashtavakra Gita 1.3, 1.7 · Tathāgata

31

THE ETERNAL NAME

Take off your sandals.

This ground is holy.

A flame lies here.

Your breath fans it,

the same that moved in your ancestors.

Joy and grief feed the fire,

yet the one who knows them is not burned.

The knower's name is not carved in wood;

it burns, unconsumed.

The Nameless names itself:

I am that I am.

Exodus 3:2-6, 3:14 · John 8:58 · Thunder, Perfect Mind · Tao Te Ching 1 · Genesis 1:2

32

PROFIT AND LOSS

You may read the hearts of others

and still be a stranger to your own.

You may subdue cities

and still be ruled by fear within.

To turn the gaze inward is illumination.

To befriend your own depth is freedom.

For what profit is there in gaining the ten thousand things

if you lose the One who beholds them?

Tao Te Ching 33 · Mark 8:36

33

THE GREAT RIVER

The River of the Father and the Mother
flows through all worlds,
pouring itself into every vessel,
claiming nothing as its own.
One who walks in this River
acts without self-importance,
gives without calculation,
rests without pride.
Thus they become transparent,
and the Source is seen through them.

Tao Te Ching 34 · Odes of Solomon 6

34

THE FACE OF PEACE

Hold fast to the image of the Living One
and all beings come to rest in your presence.
Peace begins when you see
that the one you oppose
is more than your quarrel.
The awakened do not persuade—they radiate.

Tao Te Ching 35 · John 14:27

35

THE PARADOX OF POWER

To let something expand, first allow it to contract.
To let something grow strong, first allow it to weaken.
A seed must vanish into dark soil,
a breath must empty before it fills.
Thus I guide by reversal,
teaching the soul through its own emptiness.

Tao Te Ching 36 · John 12:24



The Union of Opposites

Every pair is one thing, seen twice.

36

SPLIT THE WOOD

You think I am waiting
at the end of your chores.
I am the grain the axe follows,
the weight beneath the lifted stone.
The Father is not busy,
yet the fields ripen;
the seasons turn
with no hand upon the wheel.
When desire stirs, do not wrestle it.
Return to the work with a plain heart,
and desire finds nowhere to stand.

Tao Te Ching 37 · Thomas 77

37

TRUE VIRTUE

High virtue moves like breath—
it does not watch itself being virtuous.
Lesser virtue stares into its own reflection,
checking whether it appears upright.
Many admire the blossom;
the wise wait for the fruit.
A tree is not known by its flowers,
which any spring can paint,
but by what it gives in the lean months.
Do not ask whether a teacher is holy.
Ask what grows in you.

Tao Te Ching 38 · Matthew 6:1–4 · Matthew 7:16

38

THE ONES WHO REMAIN WHOLE

Heaven remains Heaven because it does not exalt itself.
The earth remains earth because it does not resist its nature.
And the soul remains whole when it refuses to be divided.

Tao Te Ching 39

39

THE LEAKING JAR

The Kingdom is like a woman carrying a jar of meal
on the long road home.
The handle broke, and the meal ran out behind her,
and she did not know it.
When she reached her house and set the jar down,
she found it empty.
So the Way moves: by returning.
So the Way works: by giving way.
Every full thing
was first an empty space.
Do not mourn the emptying jar.
You are coming home light.

Tao Tè Ching 40 · Thomas 97

40

THE THREE SEEKERS

The wise hear the living word
and let it cut them to the heart;
they descend gladly into their own poverty.
The many hear it and weigh it like a coin,
spending a little, keeping a little.
The foolish hear it and laugh aloud,
mocking what they have not yet seen.
Yet I tell you:
the Light plays in them all.
The laughers, the traders, the broken ones—
each walks toward the bridal chamber,
though some walk with their backs turned.

Tao Tè Ching 41 · Matthew 13:3–9

41

WHERE THE MIND IS

Mary asked, "Lord, with what does one see you—
with the soul, or with the spirit?"

I answered: with neither.

There is an eye between them,
and where that eye rests,
there your treasure lies.

Rest it on your name,
and you will starve in a palace.

Rest it on the Light,
and an empty field will feed you.

Tao Te Ching 44 · Mary 10 · Matthew 6:21

42

THE GREAT FULLNESS

The cup most full appears most empty.
The path most straight appears crooked.
The hand most skilled holds lightly.
The awakened make peace with paradox
and so are not deceived by appearances.

Tao Te Ching 45



The Empty Vessel

The vessel is made for what it does not hold.

43

THE YOKE OF PEACE

When the Way is lived, the ox knows its master's stall.
When the Way is forgotten, the sword is drawn in the street.
The yoke of the world is heavy with desire.
My yoke is easy, and brings peace.

Tao Tè Ching 46 · Matthew 11:30

44

THE BODY THAT LEANS

The hand reaches for the cup
before the thirst arrives.
The eye reaches for the next face
before it has seen this one.
A body that leans on a body
falls when the other moves.
A soul that leans on both
falls twice.
Craving is not hunger;
it is the fear of being empty.
Sit with the empty place awhile.
It is not a wound.
It is a door.

Thomas 87, 112

45

SEEING WITHOUT SEEKING

You cross seas and deserts to seek signs,
yet the Sign looks out through your own eyes.
Without leaving your house,
you may behold the world within you.
Without straining your sight,
you may know the One who sees.
But the eye does not see itself;
be the seeing, and the search is over.

Tao Te Ching 47 · Thomas 3 · Luke 17:21 · Mary 8 · Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 3.4.2

46

TWO DOORS

The bread is eaten until no one is eating.
The song is heard until no one is hearing.
There the Mother gathers you into her arms.

The eye turns back to find the eye
and burns in its own flame,
until only the Father's Light remains.

Each door hides
the same bridal chamber,
though it is never locked.

Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 3.4.2 · Udana 1.10 · Thomas 77 · Philip · Vijñāna Bhairava 41, 72

47

THE UNLEARNING

The scholar adds a word each day
and builds a tower toward the sky.
The seeker of the Way
lays one stone aside:
a belief, a fear, a name—
until the tower falls
and only sky remains.
Let go of all things,
and the open sky will hold you.

Tao Tè Ching 48 · Thomas 77

48

THE HEART OF THE SINGLE ONE

The Single One is good to those who are good,
and good to those who are not good—
seeing only the Light within them.
Trusting those who trust,
and trusting those who do not trust—
for trust flows from the inner being, not theirs.

Tao Te Ching 49 · Matthew 5:45

49

LIFE AND DEATH

Those who cling to life fear death.
Those who know me fear neither.
Death is but the undressing of the bride
before she enters the chamber.

Tao Te Ching 50 · Philip

50

RETURN TO THE MOTHER

There is a womb older than creation,
the deep that births the All.
It moves through you as breath,
yet it is not the breath.
She is in the taste of bread,
in the wind against your face;
rest in what you sense,
and you are resting in her.
Know the Mother of your soul,
and you recognize all her children.
Know the children as passing forms,
and you are drawn back to the Mother.
In returning to her arms
you are no longer wounded by the powers,
for you remember that you were never separate
from the womb that bore you.

Tao Te Ching 25, 52 · Gospel of the Hebrews · Thunder, Perfect Mind · Vijñāna Bhairava 74

51

THE EYE OF THE NEEDLE

The world says, “Strive to enter the narrow gate.”
But I tell you: The gate is narrow only because you carry the burden of
the many.
It is easier for a camel to pass through the eye of a needle
than for the one rich in self to enter the Kingdom.
Become small, become single,
and the narrow path becomes wide as the sky.

Tao Te Ching 53 · Mark 10:25 · Matthew 7:13-14

52

THE WIDENING CIRCLE

Light the lamp in your own heart,
and it lights your house.
Let it burn in your house,
and the street walks by its glow.
Let the street carry it,
and the town remembers the road home.
Do not begin with the world;
the world is too far to reach.
Begin at the table where you eat,
with the ones whose faults you know by heart.
How shall you know the world?
Look at your own house.

Tao Te Ching 54 · Matthew 5:15



The Unforced Life

The unforced is the natural.

53

THE CHILD OF THE LIGHT

One who lives in the Light is like a newborn child—
unafraid of serpents, unmoved by loud voices, unharmed by illusions.
The bones are soft, yet the strength is great.

Tao Te Ching 55 · Thomas 4 · Luke 10:19

54

LAY DOWN NO LAW

When I am gone,
build no fence around my words.
Lay down no law but the one I gave you,
lest the law you make
become the cell you keep.
The more you forbid,
the more the heart learns to hide.
Cleanse the spring,
and every stream runs sweet.

Tao Te Ching 57 · Mary 9

55

SOWING IN WINTER

Sow in winter,
and you will reap in summer.
This world is the winter;
the Kingdom is the summer.
Under the frost the harvest sleeps,
and under the harvest, the frost.
Do not wait for warmer days to plant.
The seed you keep from the cold
will never see the sun.

Tao Te Ching 58 · Philip

56

DIG DOWN TO THE ROOT

Do not prune the branches of your sorrow.
Dig down to the root.
Hidden, it rules you;
it moves your hands to what you hate.
Seen, it withers in the light.
Ignorance is the mother of every grief,
and knowing is her grave.

Tao Te Ching 59 · Philip · Matthew 3:10

57

GOVERNING BY NON-GRASPING

Guide the soul as you would leaven the dough:
gently, until the whole loaf rises.
The Single One governs by not ruling,
teaches by not preaching,
achieves by not striving.
Thus the world settles in such presence.

Tao Te Ching 60 · Thomas 96 · Matthew 13:33

58

THE GREAT ACCEPTANCE

The Kingdom is like the Great Sea.
It refuses no river,
no matter how bitter or clouded.
It judges no stream,
but takes all into its depth,
making them one.
So too the Living One
receives the pure and the stained alike,
until all are cleared in the vastness of Love.

Tao Te Ching 61

59

THE TREASURE WITHIN

The Living Way is shelter for all beings—
a home for the whole and the broken alike.
Beautiful words can stir the mind,
but a heart that has found this hidden refuge
quietly transforms the world.

Tao Te Ching 62

60

THE SMALL ACTIONS

Do the great work through small acts.
Respond to hatred with peace.
Untie the knot while it is loose.
Tend the vine while it is young.
Let the wound end with you;
do not send it on.

Tao Te Ching 63

61

THE LEAST OF THESE

You look for me in the high places,
and I am sitting by the road.
I was hungry, and you passed with a prayer on your lips.
I was a stranger, and you asked my name
before you would open the door.
Do not search the heavens for the Living One.
Feed the one in front of you,
and you have fed me.
Every face that asks of you
is my face, asking.

Matthew 25:35-40

62

THE PUPIL OF THE EYE

Guard the one beside you
as the eyelid guards the eye—
quickly, without being asked,
before the dust arrives.
Take no joy in what you win
or what you know.
The only joy that does not sour
is the one that rises
when you look at another with love.

Thomas 25 · Gospel of the Hebrews



The Wisdom of the Child

The child asks, and is not ashamed of not knowing.

63

THE FIRST STEP

A great tree grows from a mustard seed
hidden in the dark earth.
A house is raised from a single stone.
The journey to the Father
begins exactly where your feet stand now.
Do not wait for a holier place or time.
The bridal chamber is built
from the step you take today.

Tao Te Ching 64 · Thomas 20

64

TO EACH AS THEY COULD SEE

I did not come as I am.
I came as each could bear to see me:
to the great I was great,
to the small I was small,
to the angels an angel,
and to the hungry, bread.
I came not to make you clever,
but simple enough to see.
Do not quarrel over my face;
each of you has seen
as much of it as you could hold.

Tao Te Ching 65 · Philip

65

WHO ARE YOU TO REJECT HER?

When Mary told what I had shown her,
Peter said, "Would he speak to a woman
and not to us?"
Levi answered him:
"If the Teacher made her worthy,
who are you to cast her out?"
Beware the jealousy that wears a disciple's robe.
The Light does not ask whom you outrank.
It asks only whether you can see.
Be ashamed, put on the true Human,
and go out with nothing to defend.

Mary 17-18

66

LEADING BY FOLLOWING

The river does not boast,
yet the valley drinks from it.
The one who makes himself high
passes like a cloud;
the one who makes himself low
waters many fields.
So the Single One leads by standing beneath all,
bearing the weight of the weary,
and because there is no competition in them,
there is nothing in them to oppose.

Tao Te Ching 66 · Mark 10:43-45

67

THE THREE JEWELS

I have three treasures in this world:
a heart that will not wound,
a life that delights in simplicity,
and a soul that refuses to stand above another.
Guard these,
and you will walk in the Light with me.
Lose them,
and you will trade the Kingdom for dust.

Tao Te Ching 67

68

THE SWORD OF THE SPIRIT

Do not mistake your enemy.
Your enemy is the sleeper in you.
I did not come to bring the sleep of comfort,
but the sword of awakening.
Do you think this sword wounds flesh?
It severs the false from the true.
The sword of the Spirit is clear attention
held in the Father's Light.
It falls between fear and the one who sees fear,
between the story and the silent heart that hears it.
Where this sword descends,
house divides against itself—
the old loyalties of the self
stand apart from the call of the Kingdom.
What is of fear falls away;
what is of the Living One remains.
Blessed is the one
who lets this sword pass through the heart,
for nothing real is lost,
and the true self
stands forth whole.

Tao Te Ching 69 · Matthew 10:34 · Thomas 16

69

A TEACHING FEW UNDERSTAND

My words are simple to the ear
yet sharp to the heart.
Many copy the sayings,
but few let them unwind their old garments.
Blessed is the one
who wears the teaching as skin
and lets the former self fall away like husk.
Such a one walks unseen,
yet the world is fed by their presence.

Tao Te Ching 70

70

BRING IT FORTH

What is in you is not yours to bury.
The song you will not sing
sours in the throat.
The word you will not speak
grows teeth in the dark.
Let out what lives in you,
and it will be your life.
Hold it back,
and it will hold you.

Thomas 70

71

THE GIFT OF NOT-KNOWING

To know that you do not know—this is clarity.

To think you know while living in ignorance—this is blindness.

The awakened remove the cataract from their own sight first.

Tao Te Ching 71 · John 9:41 · Matthew 7:5



The Return to Source

To return to the Source is to come home to yourself.

72

THE COURAGE OF THE WAY

Daring without wisdom leads to death.
Wisdom without daring leads nowhere.
The Way gives courage that does not wound
and power that does not dominate.

Tao Te Ching 73

73

RISE BEFORE YOU DIE

How can death frighten
one who has already risen?
Those who say, "First I will die, and then I will rise,"
walk the road backward.
Rise while there is breath in you,
for the grave is no door
to one who never woke.
The resurrection does not wait at the end of your days.
It waits at the end of your sleep.

Tao Te Ching 74 · Philip

74

HE WEPT

At the grave of my friend
I knew he would rise,
and still I wept.
Do not think the awakened are made of stone.
The one who cannot be shaken
is not the one who cannot be moved.
Weep with those who weep;
the Light does not stand above sorrow
but kneels beside it.

John 11:35 · Romans 12:15

75

NOT IN TWO MINDS

When I had gone,
my disciples sat in fear,
asking how they could go among the nations
when I myself had not been spared.
Mary stood and greeted them,
and turned their hearts toward the Good.
Grief is not the danger;
the divided heart is.
Weep if you must,
but do not stand in two minds at the door.
What made you human
has not left the room.

Mary 9

76

BE OF GOOD COURAGE

What clings to the passing
is torn when the passing goes.
From the clinging comes the fever,
and from the fever, a trembling in the whole body.
A fist holds no water;
a cupped hand is full.
People grasp at life so hard
they forget to live it.
Open your hand, and be of good courage.

Tao Te Ching 75 · Mary 7-8

77

THE GREEN WOOD AND THE DRY

When the wood is green, it is full of sap and bends.
When the wood is dry, it is brittle and snaps.
That which yields belongs to the Living One;
that which resists belongs to the grave.
The one who remains supple cannot be broken.

Tao Te Ching 76 · Luke 23:31

78

THE STRETCHED BOW

The Father's way is like a bow drawn back:
what is high, he lowers;
what is low, he lifts.
He empties the full to fill the empty.
The world's way runs the other way—
it takes from the hungry
to feed the full.
Give as the bow gives,
and do not stay to be thanked.

Tao Te Ching 77 · Luke 1:52-53

79

THE STONE AND THE CORNER

Truly I say to you:
what is soft and willing
passes where hardness breaks.
Water, patient and lowly,
carves what the hammer cannot.
The stone the builders rejected
has become the cornerstone of the temple.
So too the gentle, despised by the strong,
uphold a world they did not claim as theirs.

Tao Te Ching 43, 78 · Psalm 118:22 · Thomas 66

80

THE END OF DEBTS

Even after a truce, resentment lingers.
But the awakened hold no accounts.
They see no debtor, no creditor—
only the One Light in many forms.

Tao Te Ching 79 · Matthew 6:12

81

THE SIMPLE KINGDOM

Imagine a small, peaceful land
where people taste simplicity
and lose the appetite for excess.
Such a kingdom is within you.
Live there, and the world outside becomes gentle.

Tao Te Ching 80 · Luke 17:21

82

THE COMPLETION

Truth does not dress itself in splendor.
Splendor often hides a lie.
I give what I have been given
and do not count the cost.
The more the Single One pours out,
the more the Source flows through them—
for they draw not from their own store,
but from the spring that cannot be emptied.
So the scripture ends where the Way begins:
in silence, in seeing,
in the Light that you are.

Tao Te Ching 81 · Matthew 10:8



Sources and Echoes

*Most sayings answer a chapter of the Tao Te Ching,
taken in order; some draw on other voices.*

Thomas numbers are logia;

Mary numbers are pages of the Berlin Codex;

Odes are the Odes of Solomon.

The Light Before the World

- The Way That Is Not Seen: Tao Te Ching 1; Thomas 113.
- The Two Become One: Tao Te Ching 2; Thomas 22; Philip on the bridal chamber; Gospel of the Egyptians (quoted by Clement); Hymn of the Pearl.
- The Poverty of the Unknowing: Tao Te Ching 3; Thomas 3.
- The Father of Light: Tao Te Ching 4; Thomas 50.
- The Powers Question the Soul: Tao Te Ching 5; Mary 15–17, the soul's ascent past the seven powers.
- The Hollow Reed: Tao Te Ching 6; Thomas 78.
- The Unforced Kingdom: Tao Te Ching 7; Mary 7 (“there is no sin”); Gospel of Truth.
- The Servant at the Feast: Tao Te Ching 8; Luke 14:7–11.
- The Teacher Who Does Not Teach: Tao Te Ching 9; Thomas 13, 108.

The Kingdom Within

- The Single Eye: Tao Te Ching 10; Matthew 6:22; Mary 10 (the mind between soul and spirit); Dialogue of the Savior.
- The Inner and the Outer: Tao Te Ching 11; Thomas 22, 89.
- The Lion and the Child: Tao Te Ching 12; Thomas 7, 22.
- The Unbinding: Tao Te Ching 13; Ashtavakra Gita 1.11 (“as you think, so you become”).
- The Return to the Unborn: Tao Te Ching 14; Thomas 18–19; Hymn of the Pearl.

- The Silence That Speaks: Tao Te Ching 15, 56; Thomas 8.
- The Great Stillness: Tao Te Ching 16.
- The Hidden Guide: Tao Te Ching 17.
- When the Way Is Forgotten: Tao Te Ching 18–19; Philip (“light and darkness are brothers”).

The Garment of Silence

- Not of This World: Tao Te Ching 20; John 17:16.
- Passersby: Thomas 42.
- The Face of the Invisible: Tao Te Ching 21.
- The One Who Is Bent: Tao Te Ching 22; Matthew 23:12.
- The Wind Speaks Briefly: Tao Te Ching 23; John 3:8.
- The Heavy Root: Tao Te Ching 26.
- The Footprints of the Master: Tao Te Ching 27.

The Power of the Gentle

- The Fertile Soil: Tao Te Ching 28; Matthew 13:3–9.
- The Futility of Control: Tao Te Ching 29; Mark 4:26–29.
- The Way of Non-Violence: Tao Te Ching 30, 68; Matthew 26:52; Matthew 5:9.
- The Healing of the Ear: Tao Te Ching 31; Luke 22:50–51.
- The Way, the Truth: Tao Te Ching 32; John 14:6; the “I am” as self-inquiry (Advaita *ātma-vichāra*); compare the Ashtavakra Gita 1.3, 1.7; Tathāgata (the Buddha’s name for himself, “one who has gone thus”), echoed in “those who walk this way.”
- The Eternal Name: Exodus 3:2–6, 3:14 (Moses at the burning bush); John 8:58 (“before Abraham was, I am”); Thunder, Perfect Mind (“the speaking of my own name”); Tao Te Ching 1 (the name that can be named); Genesis 1:2 (the breath moving); so’ham, “That I am,” the breath mantra of Advaita (compare Nisargadatta, *I Am That*).
- Profit and Loss: Tao Te Ching 33; Mark 8:36.
- The Great River: Tao Te Ching 34; Odes of Solomon 6.
- The Face of Peace: Tao Te Ching 35; John 14:27.
- The Paradox of Power: Tao Te Ching 36; John 12:24.

The Union of Opposites

- Split the Wood: Tao Te Ching 37; Thomas 77.
- True Virtue: Tao Te Ching 38; Matthew 6:1–4; Matthew 7:16.

- The Ones Who Remain Whole: Tao Te Ching 39.
- The Leaking Jar: Tao Te Ching 40; Thomas 97.
- The Three Seekers: Tao Te Ching 41; Matthew 13:3–9.
- Where the Mind Is: Tao Te Ching 44; Mary 10; Matthew 6:21.
- The Great Fullness: Tao Te Ching 45.

The Empty Vessel

- The Yoke of Peace: Tao Te Ching 46; Matthew 11:30.
- The Body That Leans: Thomas 87, 112.
- Seeing Without Seeking: Tao Te Ching 47; Thomas 3; Luke 17:21; Mary 8; Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 3.4.2 (“you cannot see the seer of seeing”).
- Two Doors: Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 3.4.2; Udana 1.10 (Bahiya: “in the seen, only the seen”); Thomas 77; Philip (“the bridal chamber remains hidden”); Vijñāna Bhairava 41, 72.
- The Unlearning: Tao Te Ching 48; Thomas 77 (“I am the All”).
- The Heart of the Single One: Tao Te Ching 49; Matthew 5:45.
- Life and Death: Tao Te Ching 50; Philip on the bridal chamber.
- Return to the Mother: Tao Te Ching 25, 52; Gospel of the Hebrews; Thunder, Perfect Mind; Vijñāna Bhairava 74.
- The Eye of the Needle: Tao Te Ching 53; Mark 10:25; Matthew 7:13–14.
- The Widening Circle: Tao Te Ching 54; Matthew 5:15.

The Unforced Life

- The Child of the Light: Tao Te Ching 55; Thomas 4; Luke 10:19.
- Lay Down No Law: Tao Te Ching 57; Mary 9 (“lay down no rule beyond what I appointed”).
- Sowing in Winter: Tao Te Ching 58; Philip (“those who sow in winter reap in summer”).
- Dig Down to the Root: Tao Te Ching 59; Philip on the root of evil; Matthew 3:10.
- Governing by Non-Grasping: Tao Te Ching 60; Thomas 96; Matthew 13:33.
- The Great Acceptance: Tao Te Ching 61.
- The Treasure Within: Tao Te Ching 62.
- The Small Actions: Tao Te Ching 63.
- The Least of These: Matthew 25:35–40.
- The Pupil of the Eye: Thomas 25; Gospel of the Hebrews (“never

be joyful except when you look upon your brother in love”).

The Wisdom of the Child

- The First Step: Tao Te Ching 64; Thomas 20.
- To Each as They Could See: Tao Te Ching 65; Philip (he appeared “to the great as great, to the small as small”).
- Who Are You to Reject Her?: Mary 17–18 (Peter’s objection; Levi’s answer).
- Leading by Following: Tao Te Ching 66; Mark 10:43–45.
- The Three Jewels: Tao Te Ching 67.
- The Sword of the Spirit: Tao Te Ching 69; Matthew 10:34; Thomas 16.
- A Teaching Few Understand: Tao Te Ching 70.
- Bring It Forth: Thomas 70.
- The Gift of Not-Knowing: Tao Te Ching 71; John 9:41; Matthew 7:5.

The Return to Source

- The Courage of the Way: Tao Te Ching 73.
- Rise Before You Die: Tao Te Ching 74; Philip (those who say they will first die and then rise are mistaken).
- He Wept: John 11:35; Romans 12:15.
- Not in Two Minds: Mary 9.
- Be of Good Courage: Tao Te Ching 75; Mary 7–8.
- The Green Wood and the Dry: Tao Te Ching 76; Luke 23:31.
- The Stretched Bow: Tao Te Ching 77; Luke 1:52–53.
- The Stone and the Corner: Tao Te Ching 43, 78; Psalm 118:22; Thomas 66.
- The End of Debts: Tao Te Ching 79; Matthew 6:12.
- The Simple Kingdom: Tao Te Ching 80; Luke 17:21.
- The Completion: Tao Te Ching 81; Matthew 10:8.

For the ancient words themselves, see *Wisdom Gospels* in the Living Way library.

Glossary of the Inner Kingdom

The Source: The nameless ground of all that is, what the Tao Te Ching calls the nameless. It is the Silence before the Father and the Mother: “From the Silence, the Word. From the Word, the Light.” It cannot be seen as an object; everything comes from it and returns to it. Met as one, the sayings call it the One.

The Father and the Mother: The two faces of the one Source, not two gods. The Father is the Source as origin and Light: what you came from, and the seeing that knows. The Mother is the Source as Wisdom and life: the deep that bears all things, the womb that bears you, the senses in which she is found, and the arms you return to. Early Semitic Christians spoke of the Holy Spirit as Mother.

The Living One: God’s own life, as in the Gospel of Thomas: “Look to the Living One while you are alive.” Jesus is “the living Jesus” because he is awake as that life. To awaken as the Living One is to know it as your own.

I am: The name the Source speaks in you before you give your own: “I am that I am” (Exodus 3:14). The Nameless names itself only so.

The One and the All: The Source seen as one, the One who sees and who bears all things, and as everything: “I am the All” (Thomas 77).

Light and Silence: The Light is the Father’s; the Silence is the Source’s, before both Father and Mother. Where the sayings speak of “the Light” alone, they mean the divine light that is also your own.

The Way (Tao): The movement of the Source through all things, without force, and the path of return to it. In this scroll it is also the Kingdom of Heaven spread upon the earth. The same word named the first followers of

Jesus, who called their life *the Way* (Greek *hodos*, Hebrew *derekh*, Aramaic *ʾurḥā*) before they were called Christians (Acts 9:2; 11:26).

Living: Awake to the Source. Thomas calls Jesus “the living Jesus” and God “the living Father.” To be living is to have come alive to one’s origin; the dead are those wholly absorbed in the surface of things. The Letter to the Hebrews speaks of “a new and living way” (10:20), in Syriac *ʾurḥā d-ḥayyē*, “a way of life.”

The Bridal Chamber: The joyful union of opposites within the world of two, and the soul’s opening into the Silence of the Source. The Silence is the ground before the two; the bridal chamber is the reunion experienced when the two are made one. The soul enters it as a bride; there seer and seen, inner and outer, the Father’s Light and the Mother’s life are no longer two. In this joy, the union opens into Silence, where “the one is shown to be none.” Both doors of practice open on it. In the Gospel of Philip it is the holy of holies, and Thomas says the single one enters it (75). It remains hidden, yet it is never locked.

The Single One (Monachos): A term from the Gospel of Thomas for the solitary or unified seeker; one who has integrated the inner opposites and become whole. In this scroll the Single One is also the Tao’s sage: a person, not God, who leads by not ruling and gives without claiming.

Soul, self, and spirit: The soul is your inner being, the one who awakens. The self, without qualification, is the false self: the garment the soul mistakes for itself. The true self is the soul standing forth whole. Lowercase, spirit is the highest part of a person, beside soul and mind, as in the Gospel of Mary; capitalized, the Spirit is the divine breath.

Nous: The “Eye of the Heart” or spiritual intellect. It is the faculty within the human soul that perceives the Divine directly, distinct from the rational mind.

Gnosis: Knowledge that is not intellectual or doctrinal, but direct, experiential knowing of the Divine. It is the recognition of one’s own divine origin.

Colophon

*This Scroll was copied in the stillness of the turning year,
by a hand seeking only to disappear,
that the Light might remain.*



May Peace Be Upon the Reader.

End of Manuscript